DOCUMENT 08 · SELF-ASSESSMENT OF CONFORMITY AND PROCESS METRICS

Self-assessment of conformity and process metrics

How an organisation checks that it has worked in accordance with SPAD, what evidence it needs and with which indicators it knows whether the method works, without certifications or promised figures

Fernando García Varela Version 0.1 19-09-2026 Under construction

6	3	8	0
conformity conditions	possible outcomes	process metrics	certifications

IN THIS DOCUMENT

01 What the self-assessment is

02 Conformity conditions

03 Mandatory artefacts

04 Procedure

05 Process metrics

06 When SPAD is worth using, according to the metrics

07 Next steps of SPAD

08 Related documents

09 Version control

Version under review: please do not circulate. The current state of SPAD (version 0.x) is not meant to be shared widely. It is public so that a small number of people can review it, give feedback and help improve it. Documents and tools are being adapted to make them reusable; this notice will disappear when the framework reaches version 1.x.

Legal notice and disclaimer. SPAD is a reference methodology provided "as is" and for information purposes only. It does not constitute legal, regulatory or professional advice, does not guarantee results or compliance with any law or standard and is not a certification. **Each organisation that uses SPAD is solely responsible for validating its results, identifying the regulation that applies to it, verifying that it is current and certifying its own regulatory compliance**, with the appropriate qualified advice. This methodology is a generic, free aid shared with the community so that nobody has to start from scratch; each person or organisation can and should adapt it to its own use. It must not be inferred that its legally sensitive parts have been reviewed by legal counsel: those reviews, for each company or sector, are the ultimate responsibility of the company, consultant or organisation that uses it. Although every effort is made to keep it up to date, some regulation may have changed without being reflected here. To the fullest extent permitted by law, the author accepts no responsibility whatsoever for the effects of its application in any organisation or for its full applicability. The methodology does not grant certification of any kind. The author accepts no liability for any use made of this content or for any decisions taken on the basis of it. The data, figures, companies and cases in the examples are fictitious or illustrative.

01

What the self-assessment is

The **self-assessment of conformity** is a structured review, carried out by the organisation itself, to check whether a system, a project, an agent or a team has worked **in accordance with SPAD**.

It is	It is not
An internal review tool.	A certification.
Carried out by a person independent of those who built.	Issued or endorsed by its author or by any third party.

It is	It is not
Evidence of methodological rigour for internal or external audits.	Accreditation of compliance with any law or standard.
Referenceable in internal documentation and, with approval, in communications with customers, always as a self-assessment.	A public claim or a seal.

Presenting the self-assessment as a certification is a breach of the organisation's governance and of the permitted use of the SPAD name (document 00, section 11).

> **Why it matters.** An honest self-assessment gives the organisation a shared definition of "done" and a set of evidence ready for whoever asks for it. A seal that nobody has granted would give false assurance and would expose the organisation if anyone put it to the test.

02

Conformity conditions

A piece of work conforms to SPAD when the person assessing checks the six conditions:

#	Condition	Evidence
1	**Decisions were taken before code was written.**	PLAN validated and reviewed with GO before the first implementation; no code in the plan.
2	**Each phase produced its artefact**, complete in accordance with its contract.	Numbered artefacts in the topic folder; automatic validation without errors.
3	**The reviews were independent.**	Model record: the AI Reviewer is not the same as the builder in any phase; human code review recorded; second human review for sensitive code.
4	**No phase was skipped or merged** (except for the groupings of the reduced version, where applicable).	Complete sequence of artefacts; validation record per phase.
5	**Fixes were minimal, justified and traceable.**	Each fix links to a finding; no refactoring outside the findings.

#	Condition	Evidence
6	**No AI approved anything.**	Complete human validation record; verdicts accepted by an identified person; residual risks accepted by the appropriate authority.

If the system includes AI (document 05), a seventh is added: **the behaviour evaluation was executed before deployment and is repeated with each change of model, instructions or data**.

03

Mandatory artefacts

Work	Artefacts that must exist
Main cycle (complete version)	Phase 0 (context and objective); PLAN; plan review; code primer; test strategy; implementation; test implementation; test review; code review; fixes (if there were findings); version; validation record; model record in each artefact.
Reduced version	Reviewed plan; reviewed delivery; version; validation record; model record.
Legacy	L1 and L2 in addition to the main cycle.
Debugging	Root cause report with verdict.
Urgent fix	Rapid diagnosis; simplified plan; accelerated review; implementation with tests; deployment with emergency approval; monitoring; post-mortem; topic of the definitive plan if the fix was provisional.
Security	Security review report; acceptance of residual risks by a person.
System that includes AI	Behaviour evaluation report; versioned evaluation sets.

The absence of a mandatory artefact automatically produces a **negative** self-assessment.

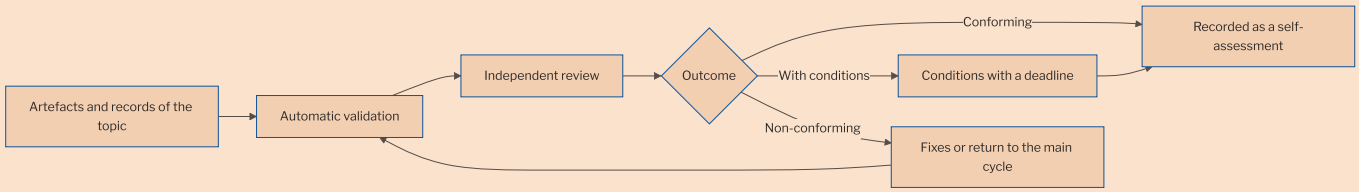
04

Procedure

Step	Who	What
1 · Collection	Owner of the work	Gathers the artefacts of the topic and the records.
2 · Automatic validation	Artefact validator (document 07)	Checks completeness, scales and consistency of verdicts.
3 · Independent review	Person designated by the organisation, **independent of those who built and orchestrated**	Checks the conditions of section 2 against the evidence.
4 · Outcome	Reviewing person	**Conforming** · **Conforming with conditions** (with the conditions and their deadline) · **Non-conforming** (with the reasons).
5 · Correction	Team	Only through the fixes phase; no redesign is admitted at this stage. If a redesign is needed, the work goes back to the main cycle and the self-assessment is repeated.
6 · Record	Organisation	Notes the outcome, the reviewing person, the date and the scope, always as "conforming with SPAD (self-assessment)".

Self-assessment of conformity

From the evidence to the outcome, without certification



Source: SPAD

4.1 Scope and validity

- Each self-assessment has a **scope** (system, project, agent, team or component) and a **date**.
- Validity: whatever the global context sets (starting value: twelve months), or less if there are significant changes in architecture or scope, agents or new decision logic are introduced, or the model of a system that includes AI changes without repeating the behaviour evaluation.

4.2 Governance

- The outcome is final within the organisation.
- The reviewing person is independent of those who built; in organisations that apply SEVEN-G, that fact alone does not make them the AI Auditor, who is also subject to the SEVEN-G

incompatibilities.

- The evidence is kept in accordance with the organisation's retention policy.
- In SEVEN-G, the self-assessment **is not** decision gate evidence and does not exempt from any: it is an input (SEVEN-G 53 · Building solutions with AI, section 2.2).

05

Process metrics

SPAD **does not claim improvement figures**. Each organisation measures whether the method works against its own baseline, with these indicators calculated from the records (document 02):

#	Metric	Formula	What it indicates
1	**Invalidation rate per phase**	Invalid responses ÷ responses of the phase × 100	Phases with weak instructions or unsuitable models. Above the threshold of the global context, the instruction is reviewed.
2	**Invalidation rate per model**	Invalid responses of the model ÷ responses of the model × 100	Which models follow the rules best; basis for switching models per role.
3	**NO-GO rate**	Reviews with NO-GO ÷ reviews × 100, per type of review	Quality of the design and the build before review. A sustained zero rate indicates a nominal review.
4	**Iterations to GO**	Mean and maximum iterations per reviewed phase	Cost of rework within the cycle.
5	**Time per phase**	Median time between entry into and validation of each phase	Where the bottleneck is; basis for calibrating the reduced version.
6	**Escaped defects**	Defects detected in production attributable to a topic ÷ topics delivered	Effectiveness of the set of reviews. The figure that really matters.
7	**Actual versus required coverage**	Coverage obtained − minimum coverage, per topic	Compliance with the test strategy.
8	**Fixes outside a finding**	Fixes without an associated finding ÷ fixes × 100	Disguised refactoring. It should tend to zero.

For systems that include AI, the metrics of the behaviour evaluation are added (accuracy, correct refusal, adversarial tests passed, difference per segment) and, in operation, drift and cost per interaction (document 05).

Outcome metric (against the baseline)	How to measure it
Rework after delivery	Hours of fixes after the version ÷ hours of build, before and after SPAD.
Incidents in production	Incidents per topic delivered, before and after.
Audit preparation time	Hours to gather the evidence of a topic, before and after.
Time to production	Median days from phase 0 to the version, per type of work.

> **Why it matters.** The original SPAD materials promised specific reductions in rework and incidents. SEVEN-G does not use unsupported figures and neither does SPAD: the metrics in this section are the way for each organisation to obtain its own figures, and for the methodology to be calibrated with data rather than with expectations.

06

When SPAD is worth using, according to the metrics

Signal in the metrics	Reading
High invalidation rate in one phase and low in the others	The instruction for that phase needs strengthening; it is not a problem of the method.
NO-GO rate close to zero for months	The AI Reviewer or the human validation have become a formality; review the independence.
Time per phase far above the build time in small pieces of work	Apply the reduced version to those pieces of work.
Escaped defects that do not fall after several cycles	Review the test strategy and the behaviour evaluation; consider additional human review.
Growing fixes outside a finding	The AI Fixer is refactoring; strengthen the prohibition and the review.

07

Next steps of SPAD

Step	Description	Status
Artefact validator	Serverless tool that checks the contracts (document 07, section 6) and generates the topic register.	Proposed.
Context templates	Example global and project contexts, with starting values marked as such.	Proposed.
Metrics calculator	From the validation records and the violation log, the metrics of section 5.	Proposed.
Application cases	Complete fictitious examples of a topic in the complete version and in the reduced version.	Proposed.

08

Related documents

Document	Relationship
document 00 · What SPAD is and how it helps	Permitted use of the name and absence of certification.
document 01 · Operating guide	Phases and artefacts whose existence is checked.
document 02 · Contexts, topics and artefact register	Records from which the evidence and the metrics come.
document 03 · Validation policy	Invalidation rate and violation log.
document 07 · Input and output contracts	Automatic validation prior to the independent review.
SEVEN-G 53 · Building solutions with AI	Treatment of the self-assessment within SEVEN-G.

09

Version control

Version	Date	Changes
0.1	19-09-2026	First version. Rewrites the previous self-assessment: nature, six conditions with evidence (seven for systems with AI), mandatory artefacts aligned with the canonical cycle and the complementary cycles, procedure with automatic validation, scope and validity as a parameter, governance; adds the process and outcome metrics and the next steps.